Task 1 – example student response

Activity A (i)

Planning and system requirements

Minimum specification required for downloading the ToKa Fitness website

System requirements

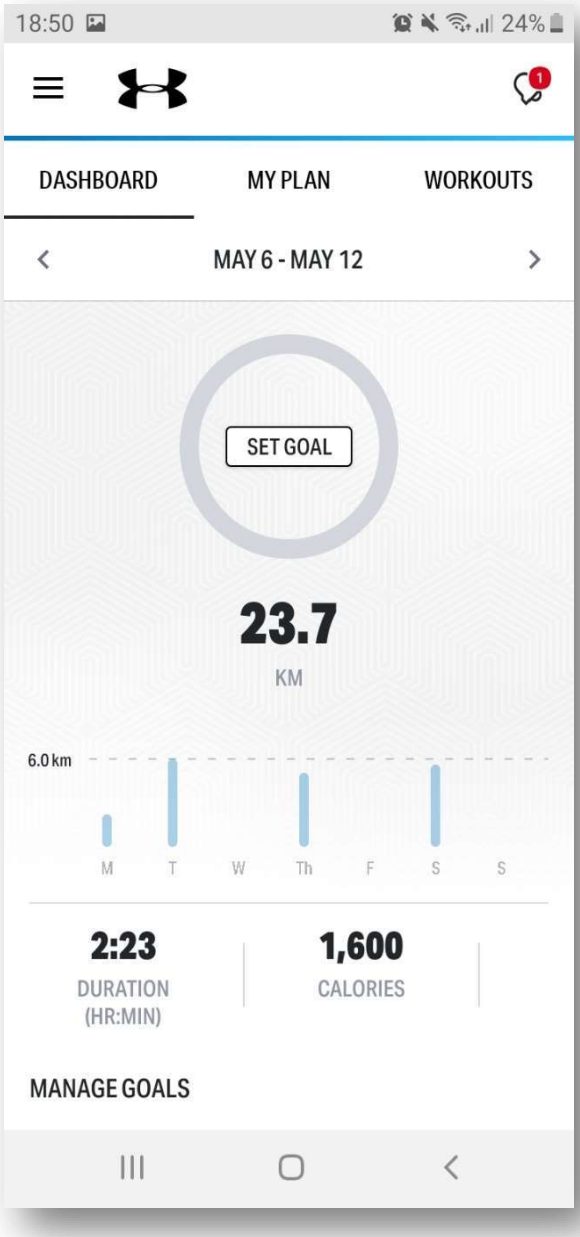
- Processor: 1 gigahertz (GHz) or faster processor or SoC
- RAM: 1 gigabyte (GB) for 32-bit or 2 GB for 64-bit
- Hard disk space: 16 GB for 32-bit OS 20 GB for 64-bit OS
- Graphics card: DirectX 9 or later with WDDM 1.0 driver
- Display: 800x600

Mobile device

- 1.3GHz dual-core processor
- 1GB of RAM
- iOS 6.1.4
- 1,440mAh battery

Research

There are many pre-existing website and apps that are designed to track cardio only – UA's MapMyRun being one of the most popular, followed by RunKeeper, Strava. MapMyRun tracks your workout in real time where the user just presses start/pause/stop and then completes their workouts with the app running. This then uses location software to track your running route and therefore your speed and distance, which can be used to calculate more complicated averages over each kilometre and the entire workout. However, as this is in real time, my personal experience is that the location services used by MapMyRun sometimes fail, especially if power saving modes are on. This is very frustrating for users who have finished their workout, only to discover that none or only some or inaccurate statistics have been recorded. Strava works similarly but is intended for cyclists. These are



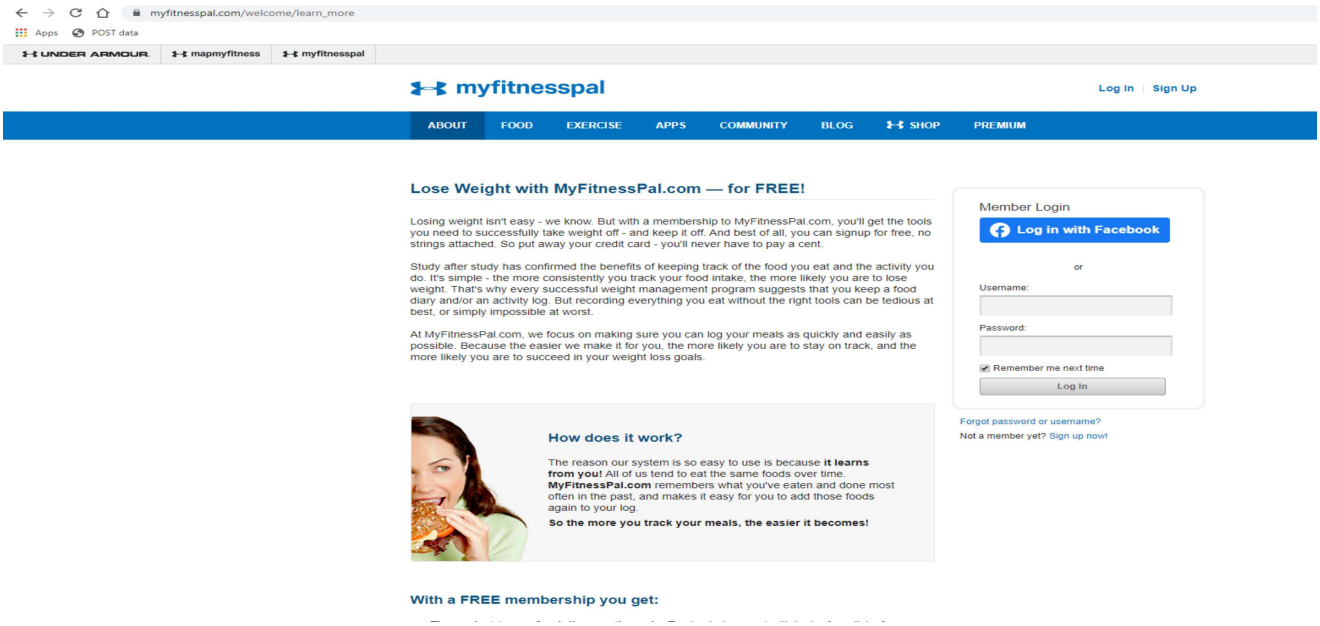
limited to either running or cycling only, so do not provide the facilities for users to log all the types of workout they complete or allow users to see progress comparisons between cardio improvements and strength improvements. The client would like it to be convenient for users to track all types of workout in one place – it's a hassle to track different things in different places, often causing people to resort to non-technological solutions such as writing things down in a notebook. However, they do provide useful features, as the focus on cardio tracking allows them to calculate stats on each workout such as average pace, pace per kilometre and combine stats from workouts showing kilometres per week and potentially demonstrate progress in distance and speed over time. This statistical analysis is important to clients as it provides useful information for the user to continue to make progress with an understanding of what has worked in the past.

Other pre-existing fitness applications include those that are dedicated to fitness in general – UA's MyFitnessPal for example allows users to log their food intake as well as a range of predetermined sports, and calculates their overall calorie needs, intake and expenditure, as well as providing guidance on macros and showing complex statistics on eating habits. However, it has no facility for users to create workouts based on strength exercises or even

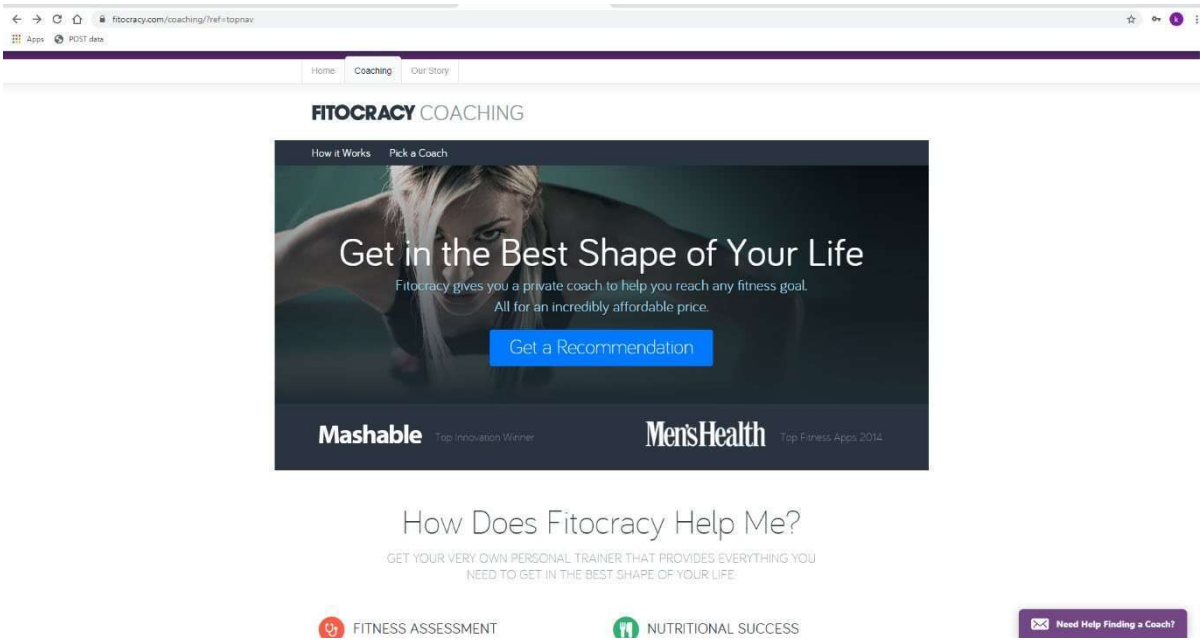
just track the exercise itself, as the application is focused on calorie usage. However, it is a very popular app with a very easy to use UI, depicting each day on one screen and allowing the user to flick between, so I would like to take guidance from its interface as I have found it to be the easiest to use. Most of these general fitness applications also have premium features only accessible to those who pay, usually the features that allow users to customise their experience more. MyFitnessPal also interfaces with many applications such as the preinstalled Samsung Health, other UA apps such as MapMyRun or MapMyRide, and wearable technology such as heart rate monitors and shoes with GPS or accelerometers inside.

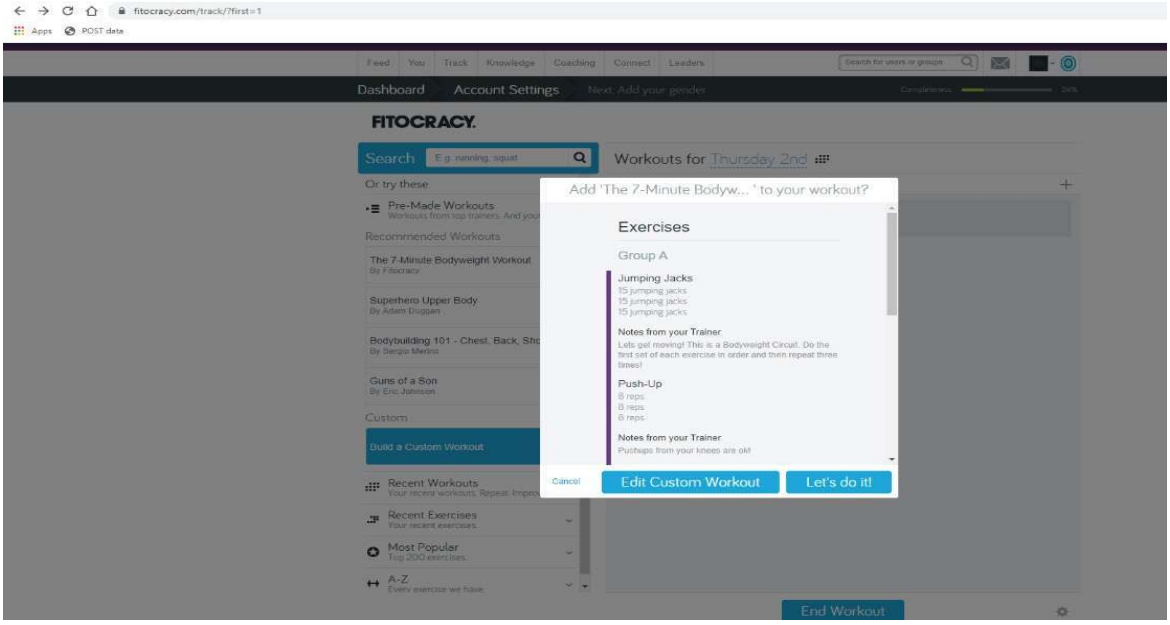
These are screenshots of MyFitnessPal – the first gives an example of how a logbook could be created, with one day on each page. However, as workouts tend to be a few times a week as opposed to daily, the UI will be designed with more of an emphasis on the long-term view, e.g. per week or per month as opposed to daily statistics. The second screenshot shows how MyFitnessPal uses the data input by the user to show them their habits. This screen gives a pie chart showing how much of your daily calories is used in each meal, with percentages and total calories shown in the key below.

Other general fitness apps include ones that come preinstalled – Samsung Health, GoogleFit, and Health (for IOS) are the most common. As these are built and maintained by the manufacturers, they have little to no problems with them and have well-designed interfaces with lots of customer support. However, one of these apps is preinstalled on almost every mobile phone sold, meaning the app must be standard for millions of customs and therefore only provides very basic functions such as step/kilometres per day counters, and weight trackers. Some of these provide more features such as Google Fit's automatic activity log, but in general, as these must be applicable to millions of customs, the features are very limited.



FITOCRACY COACHING





This website was particularly impressive, you can sign up for free, and it provides you with workout programmes and personal trainers you can select depending on what your goals are. Found it easy to navigate, you can also view other members' progress and what problems they have encountered on a live feed. Once you have selected you to workout session, you can then log your progress as shown below. I found this to be very valuable.

Web Usability

Usability will be based on research done by Nielsen (2016), who specified five components that can be used to measure the success of the website.

- **Learnability:** How easy is it for the user to accomplish basic tests first time they encounter the design?
- **Efficiently**: Once the user has learned the design, how quickly can they perform tasks?
- **Memorability**: When the user returns to the design after a period of not using it how easy is it to re-establish proficiency?
- **Errors:** How many errors does the user make, how severe are these errors and how quickly does the user recover from them?
- **Satisfaction:** How pleasant is it to use the design>

Using these elements, the website usability will be seriously enhanced, and therefore the elements will be embedded in the development process.

Homepages are the most valuable real estate in the world (Nielsen 2016). A homepage is fundamental to the success of the organisation, as this is the portal into the organisation. For example, you wouldn't go into a restaurant if dirty dishes were left on the table, and the floor was dirty, no matter how nice it looked from the outside. Derek Powazek (2006) believes that the number one job is to ensure the homepage achieves its goal by answering "what is this place". Powazek believes that if the visitor is unfamiliar with the site, and you haven't done a good job of answering that question, the user will feel dumb, leave and never come back. An analogy is the idea that if you met someone and they made you feel like an idiot, you wouldn't hang around with them anymore.

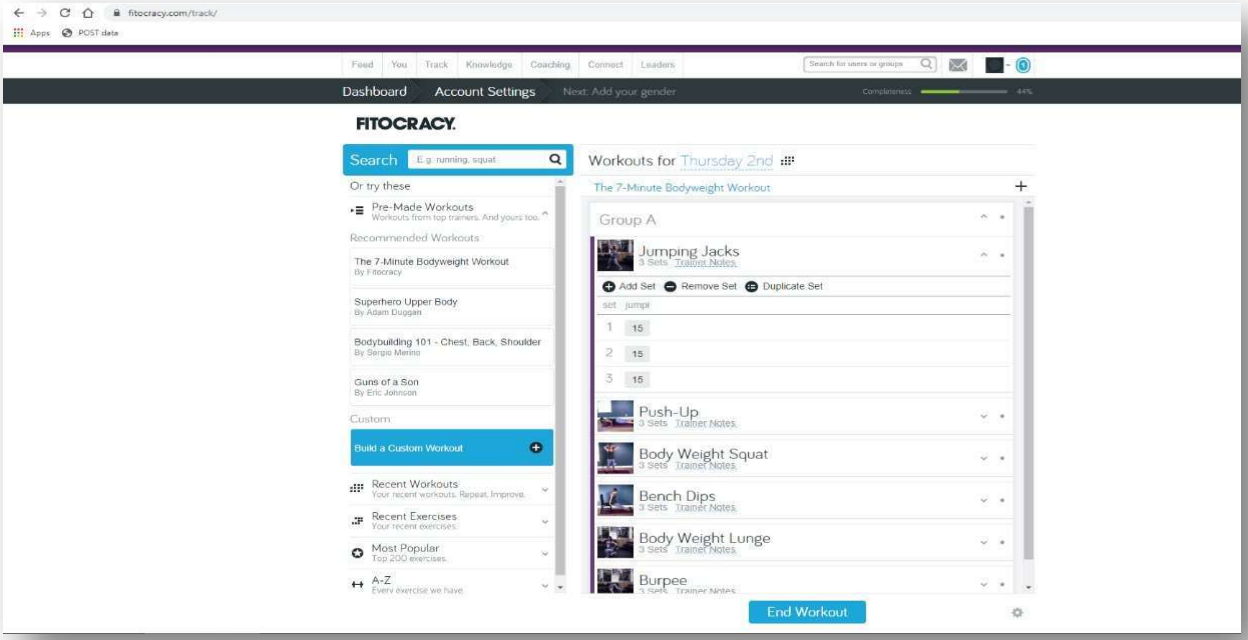
The page design is vitally important to ensure that pages are visible using any current browser technology. Most users are looking at a single page at one time. One of the key issues that will impact on the web usability is ensuring that the structure of the page can properly help with the page identity. Important features to consider are page title, subheadings, and areas sectioned off so that each component is easily identified but still within the context of the website.

Navigation is one of the hardest elements of the page and site development, this is partly because it is very subjective as everyone has their own opinion on how it should work. This is a difficult issue to solve, but it is hugely important from a usability perspective. If the navigation isn't doing what it should, we risk losing visitors. A navigation system should work easy and allow the user to flow from action to action and from place to place. For example, on the homepage it is important to avoid scrolling from left to right, as scrolling can cause accessibility problems and can be difficult for users with motor skill impairment, low literacy users and elderly users who often have trouble getting to the right spot in scrolling menus.

Another important challenge is for the site to cater for repeat visitors who already know what they are doing, as well as catering for new visitors. Powazek (2006) suggests that one technique that conquers this is to make one area of the page dynamic. Once we have catered for new people and repeat visitors it is important that we then ensure that the site remains impressive with something attractive for both new and repeat visitors. An

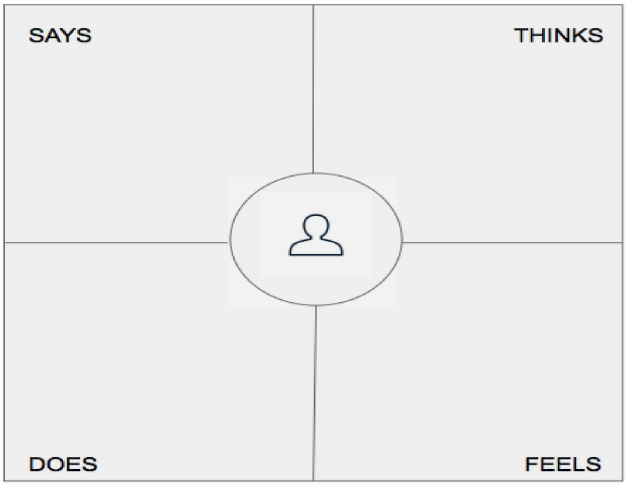
idea to cater for this is to add a forum . It is worth noting that, according to Powazek, too many sites fail before achieving these first two fundamental goals.

Content within the page is also important. However, users look at headlines before deciding if the content is likely to be of interest to them. They will scan areas of the page for ideas that indicate where to go (Nielsen 2000). With this in mind, both headlines and content are pivotal to website success, and having the ability to understand how web users access content is very important but, according to Nielsen, is easily underestimated. It is important to remember that 79% of web users scan rather than read, which may be due to time constraints, to tiredness as eyes are 25% slower than



reading on paper, and to the nature of user driven medium where the user feels the need to click on to new things.

Empathy Map



Empathy mapping is an efficient tool used to understand user behaviours, but also to help to communicate the findings visually.

When conducting user research, we learnt a lot about the users—through what they say and do, as well as through more subtle clues like body language and facial expressions. By using empathy mapping to help visualise all these findings, it presented the data gathered about users during the research phase in a condensed, easily digestible format.

The information was gathered from interviews, product reviews, surveys, and then sorted into the four sections of the map. So, research conducted look at the following areas:

- Who is the ideal customer?
- What are the current behaviour patterns of my users?
- What are the needs and goals of the users?
- What issues and pain-points do they currently face within the given context?

The results will be used to formulate the design in task 2.